

YUME

夢

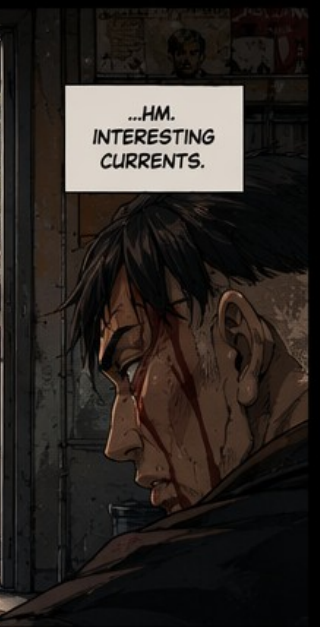
SEASON 1

EPISODE 09: THE GYM BAG

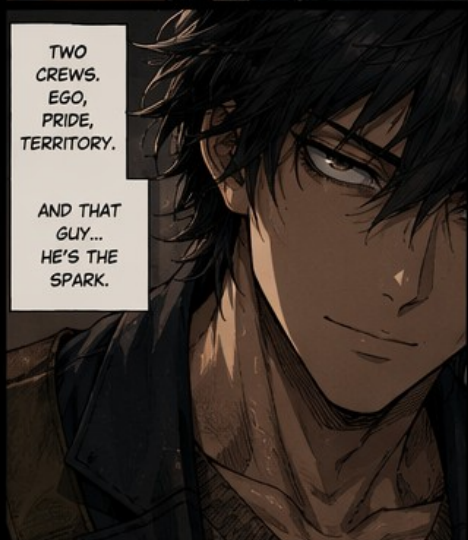


HMPH.
NOTHIN' BUT
YOUNG BLOOD
AND OLD
BEEF.

SAME AS
IT EVER
WAS.

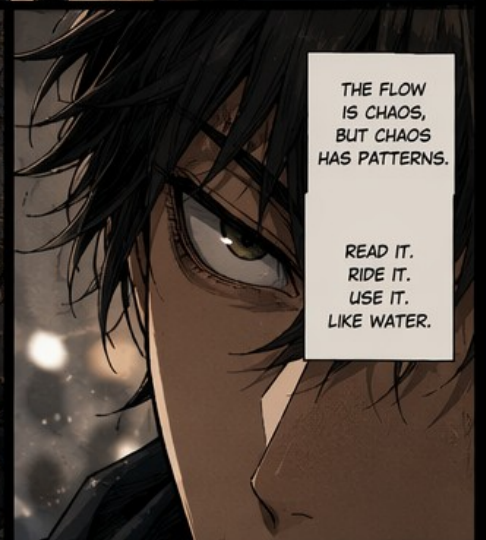


...HM.
INTERESTING
CURRENTS.



TWO
CREWS.
EGO,
PRIDE,
TERRITORY.

AND THAT
GUY...
HE'S THE
SPARK.



THE FLOW
IS CHAOS,
BUT CHAOS
HAS PATTERNS.

READ IT.
RIDE IT.
USE IT.
LIKE WATER.



LET'S SEE
HOW DEEP
THIS RABBIT HOLE
GOES.

...THIS
SHOULD BE
FUN.



THEY CAME
IN A PACK.
TWENTY MEN.
THREE SIDES.
ONE NIGHTMARE.

THEY DIDN'T KNOW
I WASN'T HERE TO
FIGHT BACK.



I CAME TO
WALK THROUGH.

LIKE SMOKE.



DIE,
FREAK!

HE THREW
HIS HAYMAKER.

I LET HIM
MISS...



THWACK!

...AND CARRY HIM
INTO SOMETHING
WORSE.



YOU'RE
DEAD!

BRASS KNUCKLES.

HE AIMED
FOR MY HEAD.



CRACK!

I MOVED.
NOT FAST.

JUST
ENOUGH.

HIS FACE
FOUND THE
FIST INSTEAD.



I DIDN'T THROW
A SINGLE PUNCH.

I JUST
KEPT
MOVING.

THEY CALLED IT
A FIGHT.

I CALL IT
PASSAGE.



LOOKS
LIKE...

YOU'RE
ALL A LITTLE
SLOW.



WHA—

...

WHAT JUST
HAPPENED?



HE... DIDN'T
HIT ANYONE.

BUT THEY
ALL WENT
DOWN...



A FIGHT
ISN'T JUST
ABOUT HITTING.

IT'S ABOUT
KNOWING WHERE
TO BE...

...AND WHERE
NOT TO.



I'VE NEVER
SEEN ANYTHING
LIKE THAT...



GUH...

NHH...

BLACKCOIL FIGHT CLUB TOKYO, JAPAN

MEMBERS ONLY.

NO CAMERAS.
NO COPS.
NO MERCY.

黒蛇



...HM.

NOT BAD,
KID.



JUST
ANOTHER
NIGHT.

MEMBERSHIP CARDS.



VENUE
PASSES.



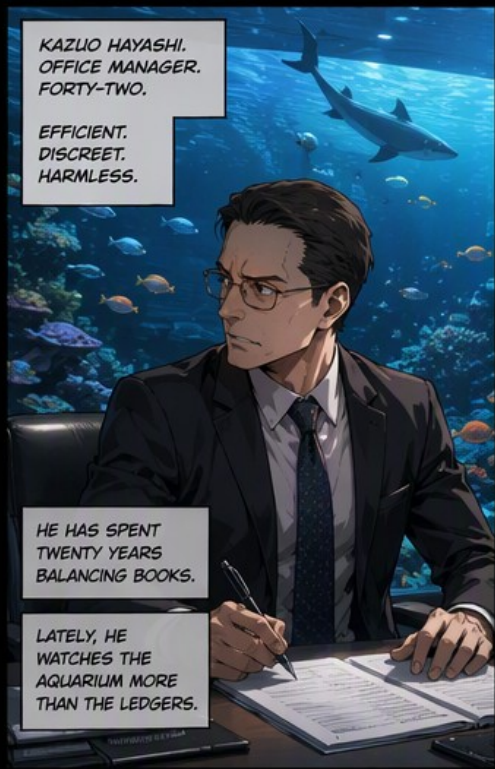
PLACES
MOST CAN'T
EVEN FIND.



ANOTHER
MESS.
ANOTHER
CLEANUP.
THAT'S THE
GAME.

SANPAKU EYES.
WHITE BELOW.
ALWAYS WATCHING.

THEY SAY IT MEANS
A MAN WHO'LL
DIE YOUNG.
THEY'RE RIGHT.
I JUST HAVEN'T
DECIDED WHEN.



KAZUO HAYASHI.
OFFICE MANAGER.
FORTY-TWO.

EFFICIENT.
DISCREET.
HARMLESS.

HE HAS SPENT
TWENTY YEARS
BALANCING BOOKS.

LATELY, HE
WATCHES THE
AQUARIUM MORE
THAN THE LEDGERS.



UNDERNET MERCENARIES.
NOT SECURITY.
NOT COPS.
SOMETHING ELSE.



PAYROLL FOR
NIGHTCLUBS.
CASINOS.
IDOL TOURS.

THE KIND OF
MONEY THAT
DOESN'T ASK
QUESTIONS.



MEGUMI SATO.
SPECIAL PAYROLL
COORDINATOR.
TWENTY-EIGHT.

SHE'S BEEN
UNDERESTIMATED
HER WHOLE LIFE.
SHE'S USED TO IT.



T-THEY'RE
NOT HERE FOR
THE MONEY...

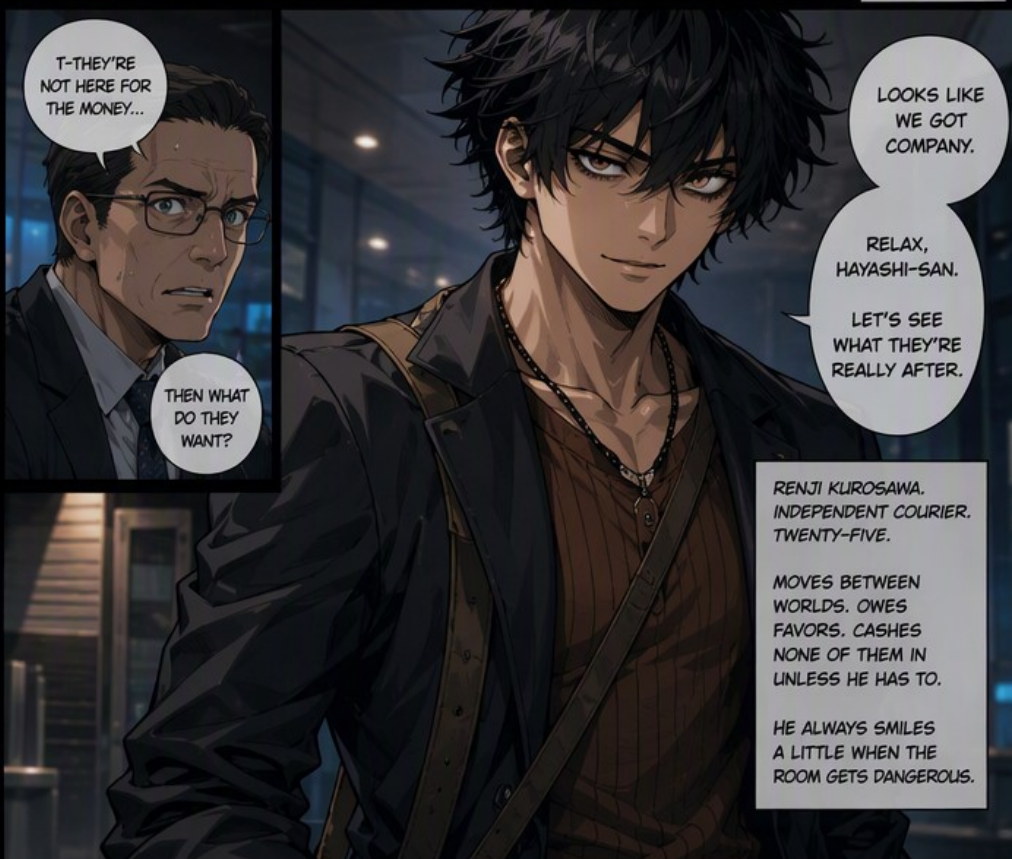
THEN WHAT
DO THEY
WANT?



EVERYONE
STAY WHERE
YOU ARE.

THIS ISN'T
A ROBBERY.

IT'S A
SEARCH.



LOOKS LIKE
WE GOT
COMPANY.

RELAX,
HAYASHI-SAN.

LET'S SEE
WHAT THEY'RE
REALLY AFTER.

RENJI KUROSAWA.
INDEPENDENT COURIER.
TWENTY-FIVE.

MOVES BETWEEN
WORLDS. OWES
FAVORS. CASHES
NONE OF THEM IN
UNLESS HE HAS TO.

HE ALWAYS SMILES
A LITTLE WHEN THE
ROOM GETS DANGEROUS.



SOME PEOPLE
SPEND THEIR WHOLE
LIVES THINKING
THEY'RE IN CONTROL.

THEY'RE NOT.

NOT REALLY.



WHAT THE HELL
ARE YOU DOING?!



GET OUT
OF MY WAY.



KRAAASH



BOOOOOM



AAAHH!



NOW...

THAT'S
CONTROL.

THE MERCENARIES
NEVER SAW IT COMING.

KRA-

WOOOOM

I'VE BEEN
UNDERESTIMATED
MY WHOLE LIFE.

IT'S
USEFUL.

PEOPLE SEE
PAYROLL.

THEY DON'T SEE
THE PERSON
WHO PAYS.

AGH!

YOU GOOD?

DAMMIT!
HOLD ON!

I'M
FINE.

SURVIVAL
ISN'T ALWAYS
ABOUT STRENGTH.

LET'S
GET PAID.

SOMETIMES,
IT'S ABOUT
KNOWING HOW
TO RIDE.



THE TIDAL SURGE
CARRIES THE LAST OF
THE MERCENARIES
STRAIGHT OUT INTO
OPEN AIR.



THE FINANCE
OFFICE MANAGER.

CALM AS
EVER... YET HIS
EYES DRIFT TO
THE AQUARIUM.

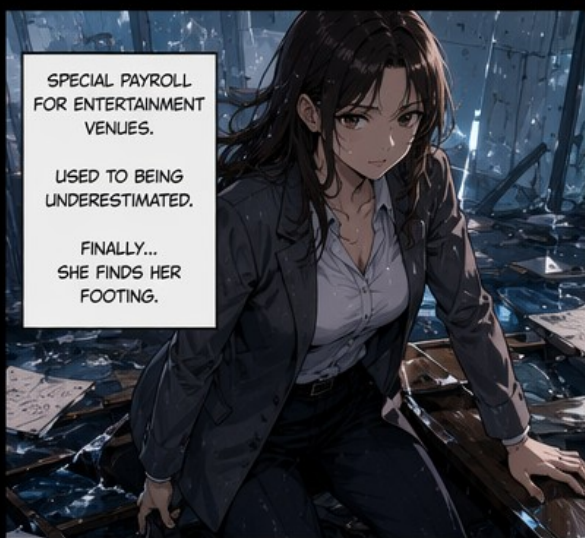
LEDGERS CAN
WAIT...

THEY ALWAYS
CAN.



SANPAKU EYES.
A SLIVER OF WHITE
BENEATH BOTH
IRISES.

CONFIDENCE
WITHOUT NOISE.



SPECIAL PAYROLL
FOR ENTERTAINMENT
VENUES.

USED TO BEING
UNDERESTIMATED.

FINALLY...
SHE FINDS HER
FOOTING.



YOU
OKAY?

NOT BAD.

CONSIDERING.



SOME DEBTS
CAN'T BE PAID
WITH MONEY.

ONLY WITH
CONSEQUENCE.

ICHIBAN KARAOKE
SHINJUKU, TOKYO
2:17 A.M.

KRRRNNNNNNNNHHH-!!

...NOT
GOOD.

AGH!
WHAT THE HELL
IS THAT?!

HIGHLINE
PRIVATE SECURITY

ULTRASONIC.
HIGH FREQUENCY
DISRUPTION.
YOU DON'T
HEAR IT...
...YOUR BODY
DOES.

EXPERIMENTAL
SONIC WEAPON?
THEY HIJACKED
THE SYSTEM?!

THOSE
BASTARDS--!

KRAAACK!

KLANK!

HIGHLINE.
PRIVATE MILITARY.
NO BADGE.
NO OVERSIGHT.
NO MERCY.

I REMEMBER
EVERY FACE.
EVERY DEBT.
THEY THINK
I FORGET?

WE RIDE
OUT THE
FREQUENCY.

THEN WE
MAKE SOME
NEW NOISE.

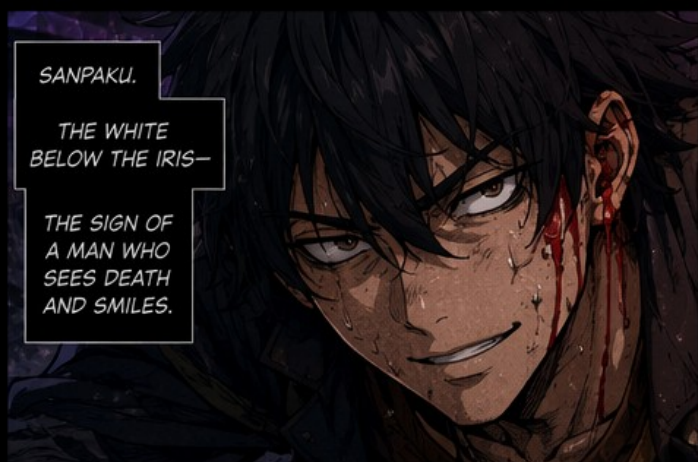


THE SOUND WAVES
HIT LIKE HAMMERS.

MY BODY MOVES...
BUT IT'S NOT
REALLY MY BODY
ANYMORE.

EVERY INCH
FEELS LIKE
DRAGGING
THROUGH
QUICKSAND.

BUT I DON'T
HAVE THE LUXURY
OF FALLING.



SANPAKU.

THE WHITE
BELOW THE IRIS—

THE SIGN OF
A MAN WHO
SEES DEATH
AND SMILES.



THE JUNCTION
BOX IS
RIGHT THERE.

IF I CAN
JUST REACH IT...



THOOM

THE BASS
DOESN'T JUST
SHAKE THE AIR.

IT TEARS
THROUGH MY
RIBCAGE.



MY EARS
ARE BLEEDING.

MY VISION
BLURS.

MY MUSCLES
SCREAM.

NNNGH



BUT STILL,
I CRAWL.

STILL,
I MOVE
FORWARD.

SCRIP...



ONE SPARK.

ONE CUT.

AND THIS
NIGHTMARE
ENDS.

COME ON...

JUST A LITTLE
FURTHER...



THAT NOISE...
NOT MUSIC.

JUST
PARASITES
SHOUTING
THROUGH
STEEL.



KLANG!!



SONIC DEVICE:
OFFLINE.

KIEEEEEEE--

POWER
LINES
SEVERED.

SYSTEM
DEAD.



THE SHRIEK
CUT OFF.

THE SILENCE
CAME BACK.

HEAVY.
BEAUTIFUL.



HEH.

FINALLY.

SOMETIMES
THE WORLD
JUST NEEDS
SOMEONE TO
UNPLUG IT.

JUST
PASSING
THROUGH.



...JESUS
CHRIST.

MY
EARS...

I THOUGHT
MY SKULL WAS
GONNA SPLIT
OPEN.

WHO THE HELL
ARE YOU?

KAWAGOE WASTE TRANSFER YARD
CITY'S EDGE

...SO THAT'S
WHY I'M
ASKING.

WHERE DID
YOU GET THAT
INFORMATION?

THIS AIN'T
A TOURIST
SPOT.

WE DON'T
ANSWER
QUESTIONS
HERE.

YOSHIDA GORO
YARD MANAGER

I WAS
HOPING YOU'D
BE MORE
COOPERATIVE.

SAITO REN
YARD WORKER

I SAID
SHUT YOUR
MOUTH.

ガ
ガ
ガ
GANN

DON'T.

GET IN HIS
WAY.

HEH.
TOUCHY.

WAIT—!

AAAAA—
!!

ゴウ
GOOOUNNN

ギギギギギ
GRRRRRRRR

TRASH LINE

CHAPTER 17: CLOSING MARGIN

WAKABA
RESOURCE
RECLAMATION
YARD
23:47

THE COMPACTOR—
IT'S NOT STOPPING!

RELAX.

I'VE BEEN IN
TIGHTER SPOTS
THAN THIS.

NAGI RYŌICHI
AGE: 26
NO FIXED ADDRESS
SKILLED NEGOTIATOR
AND OPPORTUNIST

WE'RE
GONNA GET
SQUASHED!

MIYAMOTO SOUTA
AGE: 21
WASTE-YARD WORKER
KEEN EYES. KEENER INSTINCTS.

KREEEEEE
EEEEEEK

THEN DON'T
GET SQUASHED.
PUSH BACK.

GHHNNNNN
NNN

HE'S SMILING.
LIKE THIS IS
NOTHING.

BUT THOSE LEGS—
THOSE ARMS...
HE'S HOLDING
THIS WALL.

SEE THAT
SLIVER OF
WHITE?

THAT'S NOT
FEAR.

THAT'S
AWARENESS.

SANPAKU EYES.
HE SEES MORE THAN
PEOPLE THINK.

COMPACTOR PRESSURE:
4.2 TONS
...AND RISING.

STEEL WALL
THICKNESS:
3.8 CM

WARNING
MAXIMUM LOAD
IMMINENT

THUDD
DDDD

IF THIS IS
HOW HE LIVES...

THEN I'D BETTER
LEARN HOW TO
LIVE LIKE THIS
TOO.



GUESS
YOU COULD SAY...

...I ALWAYS
WEDGE THINGS
MY WAY.

CHAPTER 27:
JAMMED



BUT SOMETIMES,
IT'S LEVERAGE.



COME ON.

DON'T LET ME
DOWN NOW.

AND TIMING.

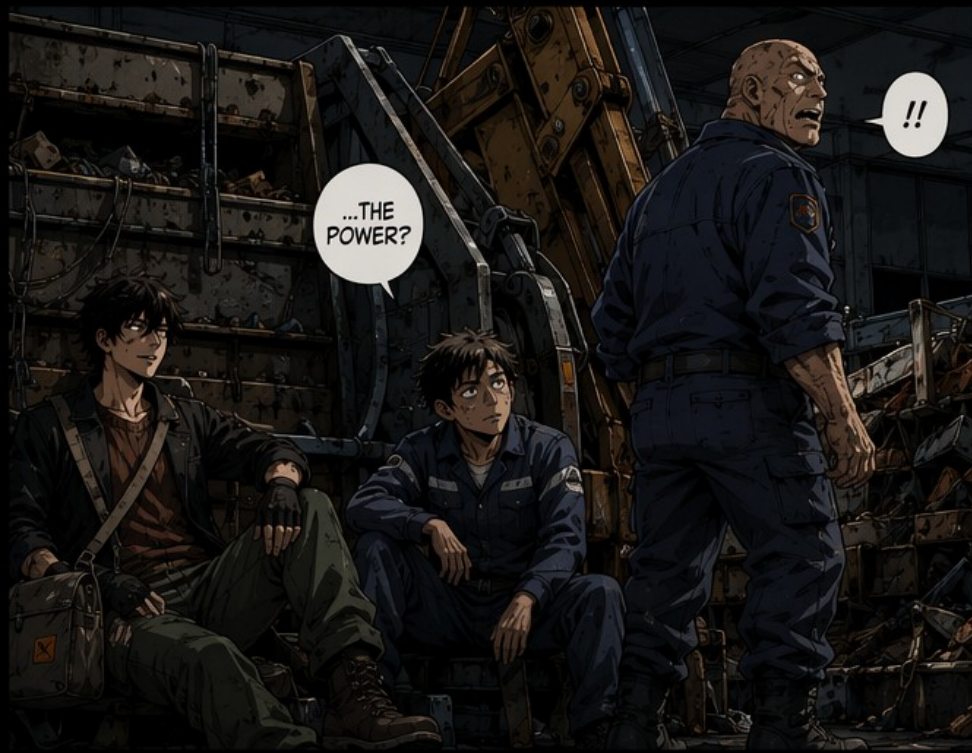


ALL THREE.

THAT'S
HOW YOU
STOP A GIANT.



...HM.
THAT'S
NEW.



...THE
POWER?

!!



KLAK



EVERY LIGHT.
ALL AT ONCE.



WHAT
THE...



THIS
CAN'T
BE...



NOT
A FLICKER.



WELL.
LOOKS LIKE
THE NIGHT JUST
GOT INTERESTING.